```
person.errors.size # => 0
```

8 Displaying Validation Errors in Views

Once you've created a model and added validations, if that model is created via a web form, you probably want to display an error message when one of the validations fail.

Because every application handles this kind of thing differently, Rails does not include any view helpers to help you generate these messages directly. However, due to the rich number of methods Rails gives you to interact with validations in general, it's fairly easy to build your own. In addition, when generating a scaffold, Rails will put some ERB into the `_form.html.erb` that it generates that displays the full list of errors on that model.

Assuming we have a model that's been saved in an instance variable named `@article`, it looks like this:

```
<% if @article.errors.any? %>
  <div id="error_explanation">
    <h2><%= pluralize(@article.errors.count, "error") %> prohibited
this article from being saved:</h2>

    <ul>
    <% @article.errors.full_messages.each do |msg| %>
      <li><%= msg %></li>
    <% end %>
    </ul>
  </div>
<% end %>
```

Furthermore, if you use the Rails form helpers to generate your forms, when a validation error occurs on a field, it will generate an extra `<div>` around the entry.

```
<div class="field_with_errors">
 <input id="article_title" name="article[title]" size="30" type="text"
value="">
</div>
```

You can then style this div however you'd like. The default scaffold that Rails generates, for example, adds this CSS rule:

```
.field_with_errors {
  padding: 2px;
  background-color: red;
  display: table;
}
```

This means that any field with an error ends up with a 2 pixel red border.